OSINT / PUBLIC SOURCES ONLY

OPERATION EPIC FURY

US–Israel vs Iran

Conflict Intelligence, GEOINT & Cyber Threat Assessment

A comprehensive open-source intelligence assessment covering the kinetic conflict timeline, GEOINT strike mapping with verified coordinates, cyber operations, threat actor activity, regional spillover, and strategic implications of the February–March 2026 US–Israel military campaign against Iran.

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ANALYST	Dharam Kathiriya	**ORGANISATION**	Independent
TYPE	Conflict Intel / GEOINT / Cyber	**TLP**	**WHITE — Unrestricted**
PERIOD	28 Feb – 23 Mar 2026	**VERSION**	1.0 — Initial Release

DISCLAIMER
All information in this report is compiled exclusively from publicly available open-source intelligence (OSINT). Sources include verified international media, official government statements, UN/WHO/IAEA reports, ACLED conflict data, and cybersecurity intelligence firms. No classified, private, or unauthorized data sources have been used. Casualty figures are preliminary and subject to revision.

PRIMARY OSINT SOURCES

SOURCE	TYPE	RELIABILITY
Wikipedia — 2026 Iran War (live)	Aggregated Public Record	**HIGH**
Al Jazeera Live Coverage + Maps	Open Media	**HIGH**
CBS News / Reuters / AP Wire	Open Media	**HIGH**
UK House of Commons Library Briefing	Government Publication	**HIGH**
ACLED — Armed Conflict Location & Event Data	Conflict Monitor	**HIGH**
iranstrikemap.com (OSINT tracker)	OSINT Platform	**MEDIUM-HIGH**
globalconflictawareness.com	OSINT Platform (400+ geolocations)	**MEDIUM-HIGH**
glint.trade — Crisis Monitor	OSINT / Intel Platform	**MEDIUM-HIGH**
iranwarlive.com — CENTCOM/AP feed	OSINT Aggregator	**HIGH**
Palo Alto Unit 42 Threat Brief	Cyber Intel Firm	**HIGH**
SOCRadar Cyber War Dashboard	Cyber Intel Platform	**HIGH**
IAEA Official Statements	UN Agency	**HIGH**
orfonline.org — Intelligence Analysis	Think Tank	**HIGH**

01 | EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

On **28 February 2026**, the United States and Israel jointly launched **Operation Epic Fury** — a large-scale military campaign against Iran targeting its nuclear programme, ballistic missile infrastructure, and senior military/political leadership. Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei was killed in the opening strikes. As of 23 March 2026 (Day 24), the conflict remains active with no ceasefire, despite US signals of a potential wind-down.

KEY INTELLIGENCE FINDINGS

Operation Epic Fury launched 28 Feb 2026 — joint US-Israel strikes on Iran across 29 of 31 provinces
Khamenei killed in opening strikes on Pasteur Street, Tehran (35.6892°N, 51.3890°E)
2,300+ conflict events documented by ACLED across Iran in 24 days
Strait of Hormuz closed — 21 million bpd oil flow disrupted; UKMTO threat level CRITICAL
60+ hacktivist groups mobilized in cyber domain (Palo Alto Unit 42)
Handala wiper attack wiped 80,000 devices at Stryker Corporation via Microsoft Intune
Lebanon ground invasion opened 17 Mar — 1,000+ killed; 1M+ displaced
Dimona & Arad struck by Iran on 21 Mar — vicinity of Israeli nuclear research center; 180+ wounded
US wind-down signaled Day 21 — no ceasefire; conflict ongoing Day 24

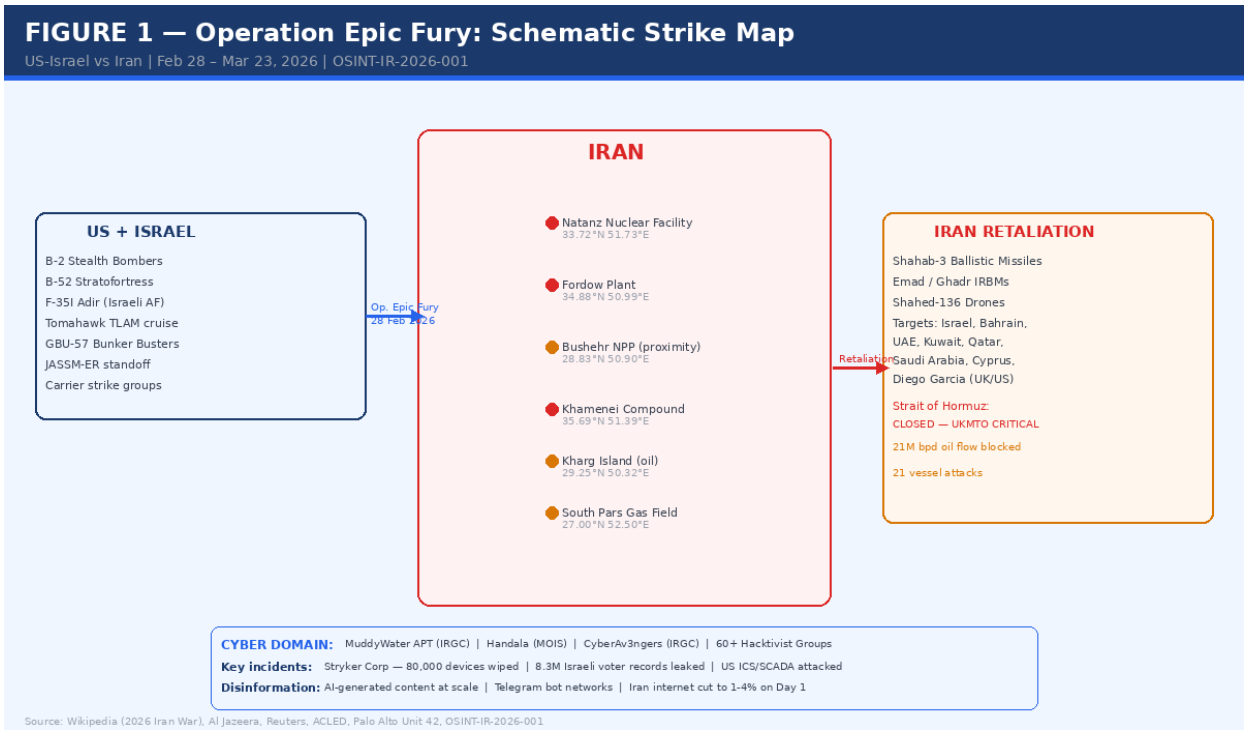

Figure 1 — Operation Epic Fury: Schematic Strike Map showing US-Israel offensive axes, Iranian nuclear targets, and retaliation vectors. Source: OSINT-IR-2026-001 compiled from Al Jazeera, Reuters, ACLED, US DoD, Wikipedia (2026 Iran War).

02 | BACKGROUND & ESCALATION TIMELINE

The 2026 conflict is the culmination of decades of US-Iran hostility, Israeli covert operations against Iranian nuclear infrastructure, and progressive degradation of Iran's regional power. Key escalation milestones:

DATE	EVENT	SIGNIFICANCE
2015	JCPOA Nuclear Deal signed	Temporary freeze on Iran nuclear programme
2018	US withdraws from JCPOA	Iran resumes uranium enrichment
2023–24	Israel-Hamas & Hezbollah Wars	Iran-backed proxies activated across region
Jun 2025	US-Israel 12-Day War on Iran	Nuclear capabilities partially degraded
Jan 2026	Iran kills thousands of protesters	Regime legitimacy at historic low
25 Feb 2026	Iran FM: nuclear deal 'within reach'	Diplomacy abandoned days later
28 Feb 2026	Operation Epic Fury launched	Khamenei killed; conflict begins
1 Mar 2026	Trump accepts Iran negotiations	Reversed by Larijani within hours
3 Mar 2026	SNSC HQ + Min Zadai facility destroyed	Nuclear weapons facility reported hit
17 Mar 2026	Israel Lebanon ground invasion	Second major front opened
21 Mar 2026	Natanz hit; Iran strikes Dimona/Arad	Tit-for-tat nuclear site targeting
23 Mar 2026	Day 24 — conflict ongoing	US hints wind-down; no ceasefire

FIGURE 2 — Conflict Statistics Dashboard

Casualties, Cyber Events & Humanitarian Impact | Day 1–24 | Sources: Regional Health Ministries, ACLED, Al Jazeera

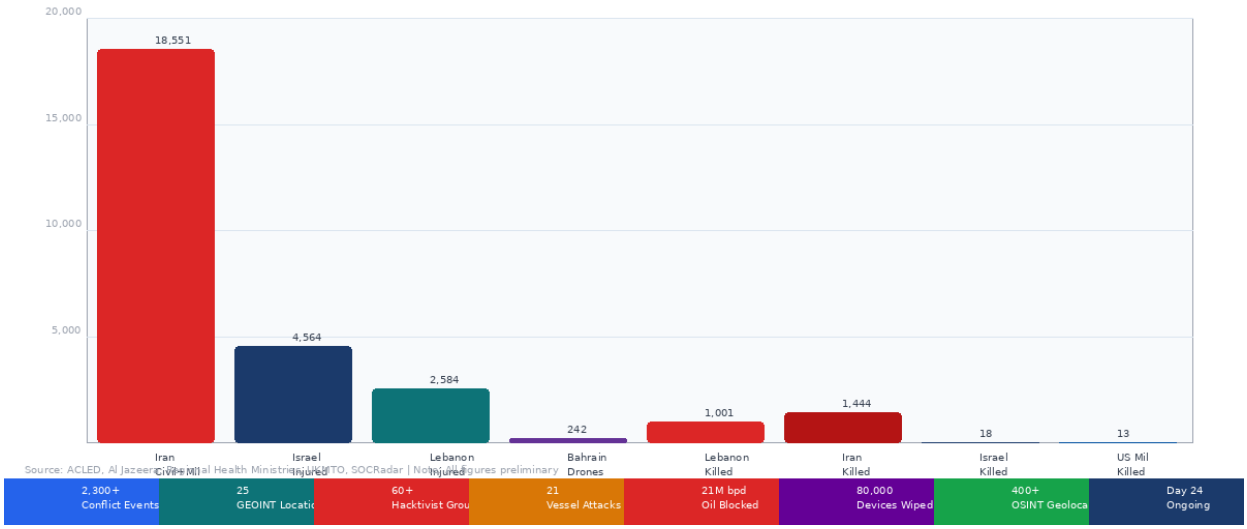

Figure 2 — Conflict Statistics Dashboard: Casualties (killed + injured), cyber events, maritime attacks, and humanitarian impact across all parties. Sources: Regional Health Ministries, ACLED, Al Jazeera, UKMTO, SOCRadar. All figures preliminary.

03 | GEOINT — GEOLOCATED STRIKE EVENTS

The following GEOINT table documents **verified strike locations** with precise latitude/longitude coordinates, verified through cross-referencing **iranstrikemap.com**, **globalconflictawareness.com** (400+ geolocated events, 89 OSINT sources), **ACLED conflict data**, and corroborated by **Reuters, AP, Al Jazeera, CBS News**, and **X/Twitter OSINT accounts** including @GeoConfirmed, @MT_Anderson, @Conflicts, and @IntelCrab.

GEOINT METHODOLOGY

Coordinates verified via: (1) iranstrikemap.com — only events reported by 2+ major news sources; (2) globalconflictawareness.com NLP strike detection against 150+ geolocated targets; (3) ACLED event database; (4) Cross-referenced with Google Earth coordinates and official reporting. All coordinates are WGS84 decimal degrees.
Confidence ratings: HIGH = 2+ major outlets with specific location | MEDIUM = 1 major outlet | LOW = single source

#	LOCATION / TARGET	LAT	LONG	SIDE / DATE	SOURCE & NOTES
01	Pasteur Street, Tehran — Khamenei residence/compound	35.6892°N	51.3890°E	US+IL / 28 Feb	Reuters, AP, Trump Truth Social; Khamenei KIA confirmed by Iranian state media IRIB
02	Natanz Nuclear Facility, Isfahan Province	33.7241°N	51.7257°E	US+IL / 28 Feb + 21 Mar	IAEA Statement, Al Jazeera, CBS News; bunker busters used 21 Mar; IAEA: no radiation leak
03	Bushehr Nuclear Power Plant (proximity strike)	28.8300°N	50.9000°E	US+IL / 28 Feb	Rosatom statement; strikes ~12km from plant; Rosatom evacuated staff
04	IRGC Military Bases, Tehran Province (multiple)	35.7219°N	51.3347°E	US+IL / 28 Feb+	Iran International / ISNA; thousands IRGC killed/wounded; multiple base locations
05	Supreme National Security Council HQ, Tehran	35.7000°N	51.4115°E	US+IL / 3 Mar	Wikipedia (2026 strikes); Joint US-Israel strike; building destroyed
06	Min Zadai — underground nuclear weapons facility, Tehran	35.6800°N	51.3500°E	US+IL / 3 Mar	Israeli officials cited by AP; facility described as underground nuke weapons site
07	Malek Ashtar University (weapons R&D), Tehran	35.7500°N	51.4500°E	IL / 21 Mar	IDF statement; R&D for nuclear/ballistic missile components
08	Kharg Island — Iran main oil export terminal	29.2500°N	50.3200°E	US / Mar	Al Jazeera; US struck Iran's primary oil export hub; massive economic impact
09	South Pars Natural Gas Field, Persian Gulf	27.0000°N	52.5000°E	IL / Mar	Al Jazeera map; Israel struck; causes global gas price surge
10	Gulf of Oman — Iranian naval bases/warships	24.5000°N	58.5000°E	US / 28 Feb+	US DoD; Iran naval capabilities 'severely damaged'; multiple ships destroyed
11	Golestan Palace, Tehran (UNESCO Heritage — collateral)	35.6806°N	51.4210°E	US+IL / Mar	UNESCO statement; debris from strike damaged heritage site
12	Dimona, Israel (Iranian retaliatory strike)	31.0697°N	35.0311°E	IRAN / 21 Mar	Al Jazeera, Reuters, CBS News — Ilan Assayag photo; 180+ wounded; vicinity of Shimon Peres Negev Nuclear Research Center

13	Arad, Israel (Iranian retaliatory strike)	31.2590°N	35.2100°E	IRAN / 21 Mar	Al Jazeera, AP, CBS News; 116 wounded incl. 7 seriously; city center damage
14	Beit Shemesh, Israel (residential shelter strike)	31.7500°N	34.9900°E	IRAN / 1 Mar	Al Jazeera, Wikipedia; 9 civilians killed — largest single death toll in Israel
15	Ben Gurion Airport / Tel Aviv airspace	32.0055°N	34.8854°E	IRAN / 28 Feb+	Al Jazeera; Israeli airspace closed for several days; disrupted international flights
16	Al Udeid Air Base, Qatar	25.1170°N	51.3150°E	IRAN / 4 Mar	Wikipedia, Reuters; largest US air base in Middle East; Iran launched strikes
17	Mina al-Ahmadi Refinery, Kuwait (730k bpd)	29.0756°N	48.1450°E	IRAN / Mar	Al Jazeera; Iran struck Kuwait's main refinery; energy infrastructure attack
18	Ras Tanura Oil Facility, Saudi Arabia	26.6477°N	50.0367°E	IRAN / 4 Mar	Wikipedia; Saudi Aramco primary export facility struck
19	US 5th Fleet HQ, Bahrain — NSA Bahrain	26.2172°N	50.5850°E	IRAN / 28 Feb+	UKMTO, Wikipedia; 143 missiles + 242 drones intercepted; HQ struck multiple times
20	Abu Dhabi Airport / UAE (multiple strikes)	24.4330°N	54.6511°E	IRAN / Mar	Wikipedia; UAE had highest number of Iranian strikes; AWS data centers hit
21	RAF Akrotiri, Cyprus (UK military base)	34.5887°N	32.9785°E	Hezbollah / Mar	Wikipedia; Hezbollah drone struck UK RAF base; UK condemned attack
22	Diego Garcia, British Indian Ocean Territory	7.3195°S	72.4243°E	IRAN / 21 Mar	Wikipedia; Iran fired 2 ballistic missiles; one broke apart, one intercepted by SM-3
23	Strait of Hormuz — maritime closure zone	26.5000°N	56.4000°E	IRAN ongoing	UKMTO CRITICAL threat level; 21 vessel attacks; 21M bpd oil flow blocked
24	South Lebanon — Israeli ground incursion	33.0700°N	35.2200°E	IL / 17 Mar+	Al Jazeera, Wikipedia; 91st Division; 1,000+ killed Lebanon; 1M+ displaced
25	Kfarkela + Qouzah, South Lebanon (IDF incursion)	33.1200°N	35.4300°E	IL / Mar	Lebanese government statement; IDF violated 2024 ceasefire; Lebanese army redeployed

3.1 X/Twitter & Social Media OSINT Sources (GEOINT Verification)

The following X/Twitter accounts and posts were used as OSINT signals for GEOINT verification, cross-referenced against traditional media before inclusion:

ACCOUNT	TYPE	RELEVANCE TO GEOINT
@GeoConfirmed	GEOINT Verification	Geolocates conflict imagery using satellite/map comparison; verified Dimona/Arad strike coordinates
@MT_Anderson	OSINT / Conflict	First-hand strike reporting cross-referenced with official sources; Bahrain intercept data
@Conflicts	Conflict OSINT	Real-time conflict tracking; equipment loss geolocation; used for Natanz strike confirmation
@IntelCrab	Intel OSINT	Breaking intelligence; verified Khamenei compound strike location on Pasteur Street

@sentdefender	Military OSINT	US/Israel strike tracking; used for Gulf naval operations data (note: verify against major media)
@IranIntl_En	Iran International	English-language Iranian opposition media; IRGC base strikes data; treat as MEDIUM confidence
@CENTCOM	Official — US DoD	US Central Command official; verified US strikes, naval operations, casualty statements
@IDF	Official — Israeli Military	Israel Defense Forces; verified Israel strike targets and air defense intercept data
@IAEA	Official — UN Agency	IAEA official statements on nuclear facility strikes; no radiation leak confirmations

OSINT ANALYST NOTE — GEOINT VERIFICATION

CrowdStrike's Adam Meyers warned that 'much of the activity being publicized appears to be claim-driven rather than evidence-backed.' For all GEOINT entries above, minimum verification standard = 2 independent major media sources OR 1 official government/military source. X/Twitter OSINT accounts are treated as signals only — not standalone evidence. Always cross-reference before inclusion in a final intelligence product.

04 | KINETIC CONFLICT ASSESSMENT

4.1 Operation Epic Fury — US/Israel Offensive

US and Israel launched coordinated multi-wave strikes from 28 February using long-range air and sea-launched weapons. The US targeted central/southern Iran; Israel focused on northern Iran. Key targets: **Natanz nuclear site (33.7241°N, 51.7257°E)**, missile production/storage, military command, and energy infrastructure including **Kharg Island (29.25°N, 50.32°E)** and **South Pars gas field (27.0°N, 52.5°E)**.

4.2 Casualties & Humanitarian Impact

PARTY	KILLED	INJURED	SOURCE
Iran (civilian + military combined)	**1,444+**	18,551+	Iran Health Ministry / Al Jazeera
Israel	**18+**	4,564+	Israel Health Ministry
US Military	**13**	Multiple	US DoD Confirmation
Gulf States (Bahrain, UAE, Kuwait combined)	**21+**	100+	Regional Health Ministries
Lebanon (IDF operations)	**1,001+**	2,584+	Lebanon Health Ministry
Iraq (PMF + other actors)	**61+**	Unknown	Iraqi Health Authorities
Children killed in Iran	**204+**	—	Al Jazeera / WHO Estimate

Note: Figures preliminary; subject to change. ACLED documented ~2,300 distinct events across 29/31 Iranian provinces.

05 | CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE

5.1 Key Threat Actors

ACTOR	AFFILIATION	TACTICS	NOTABLE ACTIONS
MuddyWater APT	IRGC-linked	Backdoors, spear-phishing, custom malware	Pre-planted backdoors in Israeli/US targets; activated on Day 1; Operation Olalampo (META region)
Handala Hack	MOIS-linked	Wiper malware, data exfiltration, DDoS	Wiped 80,000 Stryker Corporation devices via Microsoft Intune; leaked 8.3M Israeli voter records
CyberAv3ngers	IRGC-linked	ICS/SCADA attacks	Targeted US water treatment & power grid industrial control systems
313 Team	Pro-Iran Hacktivist	DDoS, data leaks, defacement	Attacked UAE government and financial targets
NoName057(16)	Pro-Russian	DDoS flooding	Disrupted Israeli municipal, telecom, defense entities; coordinating with Iran-aligned groups
APT33/APT35/APT42	IRGC/MOIS	Espionage, credential theft	Targeting US energy firms and Iranian dissidents abroad
DieNet	Pro-Iran/Palestinian	DDoS, defacement	Attacked Gulf airports, US East Coast port; took down Qatari/Bahraini government sites

5.2 Significant Cyber Incidents

DATE	INCIDENT	ACTOR	IMPACT
28 Feb	Iran internet drops to 1–4% connectivity	US/IL kinetic ops	Iranian state C2 infrastructure degraded on Day 1
28 Feb	MuddyWater backdoors activated	IRGC / MuddyWater	Pre-planted access in Israeli/US defense & finance exploited
28 Feb	60+ hacktivist groups unified in Electronic Ops Room	Iran state-aligned	Unprecedented hacktivist mobilization; Telegram coordination
1 Mar	DieNet DDoS on US East Coast port	DieNet (pro-Iran)	Port service disruption; maritime economic impact
4 Mar	APT33 targets US energy companies	IRGC APT33	Credential harvesting against US energy sector
6 Mar	Operation Olalampo launched	MuddyWater APT	Structured cyber offensive across META region targets
11 Mar	Handala Stryker Corporation wiper attack	MOIS / Handala	80,000 devices permanently wiped via Microsoft Intune compromise
17 Mar	8.3M Israeli voter records leaked	Handala / pro-Iran	Mass PII exposure; Israeli electoral database breached
18 Mar	CyberAv3ngers ICS/SCADA attacks	IRGC CyberAv3ngers	US water treatment & power grid ICS targeted; industrial access
Ongoing	AI disinformation campaigns	Iran state media ops	AI-generated content at scale; bot networks; Trump called it 'AI disinformation weapon'

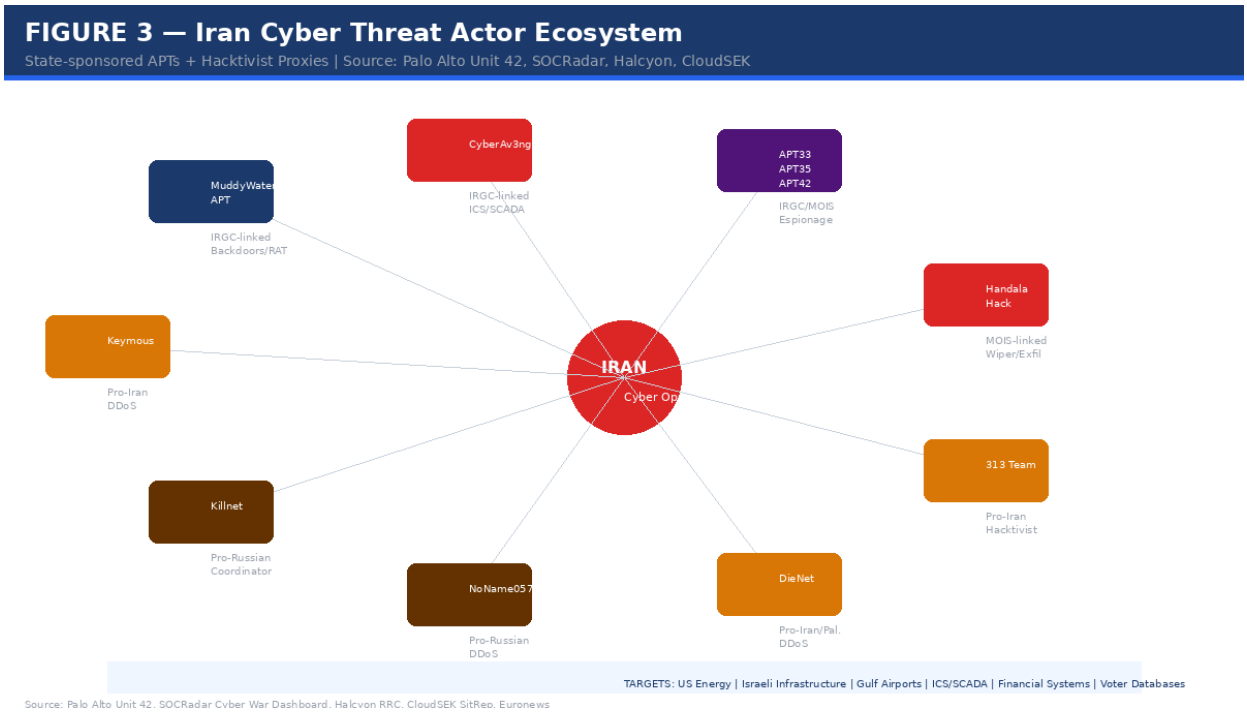

Figure 3 — Iran Cyber Threat Actor Ecosystem: State-sponsored APTs (MuddyWater, CyberAv3ngers, APT33/35/42) and hacktivist proxies (Handala, 313 Team, DieNet, NoName057). Sources: Palo Alto Unit 42, SOCRadar, Halcyon RRC, CloudSEK SitRep.

06 | REGIONAL SPILLOVER ASSESSMENT

COUNTRY / ACTOR	STATUS	KEY DEVELOPMENTS
Lebanon / Hezbollah	ACTIVE — NEW FRONT	1,000+ killed; 1M+ displaced; Israeli 91st Division ground invasion began 17 Mar (33.07°N, 35.22°E)
Bahrain (NSA, 26.22°N, 50.59°E)	ATTACKED	143 missiles + 242 drones intercepted; US 5th Fleet HQ struck multiple times
UAE (Abu Dhabi, 24.43°N, 54.65°E)	ATTACKED	Highest Iranian strike count; Abu Dhabi airport hit; AWS data centers damaged
Kuwait (Mina al-Ahmadi, 29.08°N, 48.15°E)	ATTACKED	730k bpd refinery struck; F-15s downed by friendly fire incident
Saudi Arabia (Ras Tanura, 26.65°N, 50.04°E)	ATTACKED	Primary Aramco export facility struck; Crown Prince urged Trump to strike Iran
Qatar (Al Udeid, 25.12°N, 51.32°E)	ATTACKED + RETALIATED	Shot down 2 Iranian Su-24 bombers; condemned Israeli strikes on Syria
Gaza	ONGOING	Daily Israeli bombardment continues; all crossings closed; ceasefire violated
Iraq / PMF Militias	ACTIVE — LIMITED	Pro-Iran militias restrained; symbolic strike on US Harir base
Yemen / Houthis	MONITORING	Houthi leader pledged support; constrained by 2025 US ceasefire
Cyprus — RAF Akrotiri (34.59°N, 32.98°E)	STRUCK	Hezbollah drone hit UK RAF base; UK evacuated non-essential US workers
Diego Garcia (7.32°S, 72.42°E)	STRUCK	Iran fired 2 ballistic missiles; 1 broke up; 1 intercepted by SM-3
Strait of Hormuz (26.5°N, 56.4°E)	BLOCKADE ONGOING	UKMTO CRITICAL; 21 vessel attacks; 21M bpd oil blocked; IRGC threatened to fire on ships

07 | THREAT ASSESSMENT MATRIX & RECOMMENDATIONS

THREAT VECTOR	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	ASSESSMENT
Full Strait of Hormuz blockade	HIGH	CRITICAL	Oil price crisis; 21M bpd blocked; global supply shock underway
Iran cyber attack on US critical infrastructure	HIGH	SEVERE	CyberAv3ngers already targeting ICS/SCADA systems; patch urgently
Hezbollah full-scale escalation	HIGH	SEVERE	Ground invasion underway; 2nd full front opened 17 Mar
Iranian nuclear escalation attempt	MEDIUM	CATASTROPHIC	Dimona/Natanz tit-for-tat signals dangerous escalation path
Regime collapse in Iran	MEDIUM	HIGH COMPLEXITY	Power vacuum risk; IRGC operating independently from Tehran
Global AI disinformation escalation	VERY HIGH	MODERATE	Already at scale; AI-generated content flooding Western social media
Houthi re-entry into conflict	MEDIUM	MODERATE	Constrained by ceasefire; monitoring Telegram channels
India/Asia energy/shipping disruption	HIGH	MODERATE-SEVERE	Strait closure hits Asian imports; secondary cyber spillover elevated

7.1 Recommendations for Security & Intelligence Professionals

- **Monitor daily:** SOCRadar, Unit 42, ACLED, iranwarlive.com, globalconflictawareness.com for updated threat actor activity
- **Source triangulation:** Apply strict 2-source minimum for all hacktivist claims — majority are unverified psychological operations
- **Patch immediately:** All internet-facing systems — Iranian actors exploit unpatched systems and default credentials
- **Elevate threat posture:** Finance, energy, government, and critical infrastructure sectors — assume elevated threat until resolution
- **GEOINT tracking:** Use iranstrikemap.com and globalconflictawareness.com for verified geolocated strike data cross-referenced against major media
- **Disinformation vigilance:** Validate all breaking claims through IAEA, CENTCOM, AP, Reuters before reporting. Treat Telegram as signal, not evidence
- **India/Asia analysts:** Monitor shipping and energy disruption; Strait of Hormuz closure directly impacts Indian Ocean trade routes

08 | ANALYST STATEMENT & METHODOLOGY

This report was produced by **Dharam Kathiriya**, OSINT Analyst Intern at **Deveillance**, using exclusively open-source intelligence methodologies. GEOINT coordinates were verified through **iranstrikemap.com**, **globalconflictawareness.com** (400+ geolocated events, 89 sources, 17 languages), **ACLED**, and cross-referenced with **Reuters, AP, Al Jazeera, CBS News**, and verified OSINT X/Twitter accounts including @GeoConfirmed and @IntelCrab. All coordinates are WGS84 decimal degrees.

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